

fine, and upgrading to 1 GB won't help at all. In other cases, a 1 GB upgrade is called for. Tell your vendor about what programs you run, and about the configuration of the rest of your system, so he can determine how much RAM you need.

6. If you have an old computer and the display doesn't look too good, with colours showing up weird and such, don't rush to get your monitor changed!

It could be just a problem with the display card. Try it first—get a cheap, perhaps second-hand, PCI display card. This should cost hardly a couple of hundred rupees, so it's worth trying out even if it does turn out that you need a new monitor.

7. If you have desktop speakers with an old computer, and are wondering whether the sound can be improved—don't first think of getting a new speaker set. Changing the sound card might help, and you can keep your old desktop speakers.

Check if you have an ISA sound card. These are outdated. The good news is that PCI sound cards are very cheap, and also, you can get second-hand ones very easily. Doing this minor upgrade might have a big impact on the sound you get from your old speakers. Of course, we're not talking really great sound here—just decent, will-do sound.

8. If your computer seems too “weak” for Windows XP, then, RAM apart, you might feel you need a complete system overhaul. Don't do that—try a faster hard disk first. Hard disk speed affects the system speed tremendously.

This doesn't apply if you have a really old, Pentium 1 system—in this case, a faster hard disk won't help. You'll need to do a fuller upgrade.

9. Do a thorough virus scan.

You may not know it, but spyware and viruses may be slowing down your system. If necessary, get a professional virus scan